

Ben Soyka

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Summary

Creative and motivated undergraduate computer science student looking forward to gaining real-life industry experience in a fast-paced team. Passionate about guiding others through all things technology and excited to leverage skills learned in classes and activities to help other people.

Education

BS University of Minnesota - Twin Cities, Computer Science Minneapolis, MN
 • Cumulative GPA: 3.82 Aug 2024 – present
 • Anticipated graduation: Dec 2027
 • Dean's List: 4/4 semesters

Skills

Programming Languages: Python, Java, R, C++, C, OCaml, HTML, JavaScript, CSS, Perl, C#

Tools: Git/GitHub, Amazon Web Services, Docker, Terraform, macOS, Linux, Windows

Experience

Thomson Reuters, Software Engineer Intern Eagan, MN (Hybrid)
 Contracted through Maverick Software Consulting. Feb 2026 – present
 • Assisting in maintaining a legacy backend tax return processing codebase. 7 months

Ben Soyka Photography, Photographer Apr 2023 – present
 • Run a self-employed photography business, specializing in portrait and event photography, with 100+ client galleries delivered. 3 years 5 months
 • Manage all aspects of the business, including photography, editing, client relations, advertising, and financial operations.
 • Promote services through social media, a self-designed website, and campus marketing, fostering a strong client base through referrals.

University of Minnesota Housing and Residential Life, Office Assistant Minneapolis, MN
 • Provided essential support at 24/7 information desks in student residential halls, ensuring efficient customer service while also responding to building emergencies. Jan 2025 – Aug 2026
 • Worked independently during overnight and late-hour shifts, demonstrating reliability and independence. 1 year 8 months

Projects

Wikipedia Editing Bot Mar 2022 – present
 • Used Python and AWS to develop an event-driven platform to perform daily automated edits on the English Wikipedia.
 • Reduced errors and mistakes to near-zero as the bot has performed over 20,000 trivial edits on live articles, saving human editors valuable time.

Advent of Code Practice Dec 2019 – present
 • Solved 100+ programming puzzles during annual Advent of Code events using Python, practicing dynamic programming, graph algorithms, and testing workflows.
 • Learned techniques to process large inputs with efficiency and accuracy.
 • Maintain a collection of public solutions with proper documentation and a focus on clean, easy-to-understand code.

Activities and Leadership

Twin Cities Rotaract Club at UMN, President

- Lead an active student organization dedicated to volunteering with various community initiatives in the Minneapolis area.
- Manage an executive board and officer team to lead the club's activities and decisions.
- Previously served as Vice President and Communications Coordinator.

Minneapolis, MN
Sept 2024 – present

UMN Rocket Team, Interim IREC Project Lead

- Lead the team's project to enter the 2027 International Rocket Engineering Competition (IREC) through coordination with various leads, members, mentors, and outside partners.
- Research, develop, and test high-powered amateur rocketry projects focused on testing new concepts.
- Previously led recovery for the team's winning entry in the 2026 Space Grant Midwest High-Power Rocketry Competition.
- Designed, built, and launched a [personal rocket](#) to 1,995 ft, used to earn a Level 1 certification from the Tripoli Rocketry Association.

Minneapolis, MN
Sept 2025 – present

UMN Science and Engineering Student Board, Plumb Bob (CSE Week) Co-Director

- Leading the preparation for CSE Week 2027, a five-day event to celebrate the UMN College of Science and Engineering and its student groups, after assisting with the previous year's event.
- Coordinate with other student planners, University officials, and sponsors to ensure success before and during the event.
- In 2026, focused on directing marketing and communication efforts to reach an estimated 4,000 attendees throughout the week, doubling student participation from the previous year.

Minneapolis, MN
Feb 2026 – present

Verticality Casual Climbing at UMN, Treasurer

- Serve as a founding officer of a student organization dedicated to casual rock climbing.
- Handle legal/financial matters as the club develops, including managing budgets, grant proposals, and compliance with IRS regulations and university policies.

Minneapolis, MN
Aug 2025 – present

UMN Science and Engineering Student Board, Mental Health Subdirector

- Worked with other college-level student and administrative leadership to plan events that promoted positivity in the University of Minnesota community.

Minneapolis, MN
Sept 2024 – May 2025

Awards

Operation Homefront Military Child of the Year Semifinalist

Awarded for positively impacting local military families, schools, and communities.

San Antonio, TX
Jan 2024

SevenDays Kindness Action Scholarship

Awarded for my work in creating Blue Heartbeat, a school-wide campaign for mental health awareness and positive morale.

Merriam, KS
Jan 2024

Boy Scouts of America Eagle Scout

Demonstrated long-term leadership, initiative, and commitment to community service, earning the highest rank attainable in the Scouts BSA program.

Fort Leavenworth, KS
Oct 2023

US Army Civilian Service Achievement Medal

Awarded for supporting morale activities for thousands of military family members.

El Paso, TX
Apr 2022